Motionholic

INDUSTRY RESEARCH REPORT · OCTOBER 2026

The Fitness Coach Industry Problems and Content Solutions

What fitness coaches are struggling with right now, and what to publish, produce and measure to fix it. 10 problems, 34 solutions and a 30-day plan.

Prepared by Motionholic · motionholic.com

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Executive summary

The fitness coaching market is large and growing, yet the people inside it are under pressure. Clients churn within months, AI apps compete for attention, paid leads are expensive, and coaches are expected to be full-time content creators on top of coaching. This report maps the ten problems showing up most consistently in 2026 research and gives at least three practical, content-led solutions for each.

What the research says in five lines

- **Retention is the biggest leak.** Annual churn of 30-40% and a danger zone in months 2-4 mean coaches keep refilling a leaking bucket.
- **Humans still win on trust.** Only 10% of consumers prefer AI-led workouts (Les Mills), but 91% of coaches already use AI, so the edge is human proof delivered well.
- **Video is the trust engine.** 89% say video quality affects trust and 85% say a video has convinced them to buy (Wyzowl 2026).
- **Structure beats willpower.** Challenges reportedly complete at 40-60% against 5-15% for self-paced courses, and batch-shooting beats posting when inspired.
- **Motivation is moving.** Members increasingly want longevity, strength, calm and community, not only aesthetics.

Problem-to-solution map

Problem	Strongest content move	Primary KPI
01 Client churn and weak retention	Milestone journey videos at Day 1, 30, 60, 90	90-day retention
02 Price pressure and unstable income	Value-proof videos plus an entry-level offer ladder	Close rate, MRR variance
03 AI coaches and apps eroding perceived value	Human-advantage demos and a branded method	Inbound enquiry quality
04 Rising acquisition costs and a saturated market	Niche short-form plus comment-to-DM funnel	Cost per booked call
05 Content burnout, inconsistency and algorithm pressure	Weekly batch shoot and repurposing pipeline	Posts shipped per week
06 Trust and credibility crisis	Evidence-first series and transparent proof	Booked-call rate from proof posts
07 Online delivery: accountability, compliance and form safety	Annotated form library and challenge format	Challenge completion rate
08 Trainer burnout and attrition	Systemise delivery and outsource production	Hours worked per week
09 The scaling ceiling and fragmented tools	Productised programme with video library	Revenue per coaching hour
10 Shifting consumer motivation: from aesthetics to longevity and joy	Longevity and joyful, social storytelling	Engagement, enquiry quality

Each solution in this report includes the content to produce and the KPI to watch, so a coach can act on it in the next 30 days.

Market snapshot

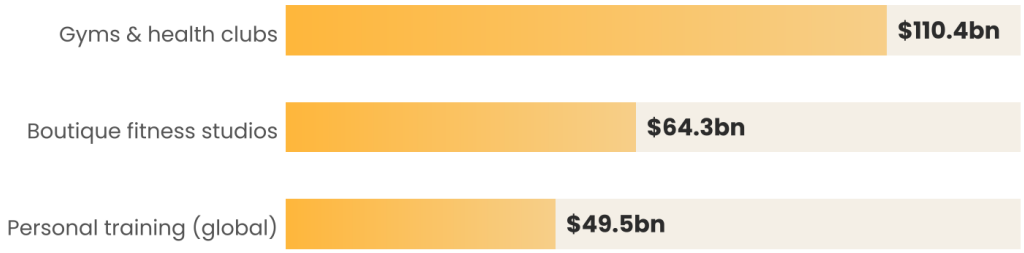
Demand is not the problem. Wellness Creatives projects the global fitness industry at about $278bn in 2026, growing near 8% a year. Personal training alone is estimated at roughly $49.5bn in 2026 (Upmetrics), and Coachway reports that 86% of trainers and nutrition coaches earning six figures train clients online.

$278bn
projected global fitness industry value in 2026 (Wellness Creatives)

~8%
projected annual growth of the fitness industry

86%
of six-figure trainers and nutrition coaches train clients online (Coachway)

Selected fitness segments, 2026 estimates (USD bn)



Sources: Wellness Creatives (gyms, boutique); Upmetrics (personal training). Publishers define segments differently; compare with care.

Why the squeeze exists anyway

- **Low barriers to entry** mean a crowded market where undifferentiated coaches compete on price.
- **Free and cheap AI apps** have reset what a generic plan is worth.
- **Attention is now the scarce resource.** Coaches who are visible, trusted and consistent on short-form video win the enquiries.
- **Retention economics** favour coaches who systemise the client journey instead of relying on motivation.

Data in this report comes from consumer surveys, trade bodies and coaching-software publishers. Several publishers sell to coaches, so their figures are indicative rather than audited. See Methodology for details.

01 Client churn and weak retention

Coaches win clients, then quietly lose them in months 2-4.

30-40%
average annual client churn for personal trainers

3-6 mo
typical length of a PT client relationship

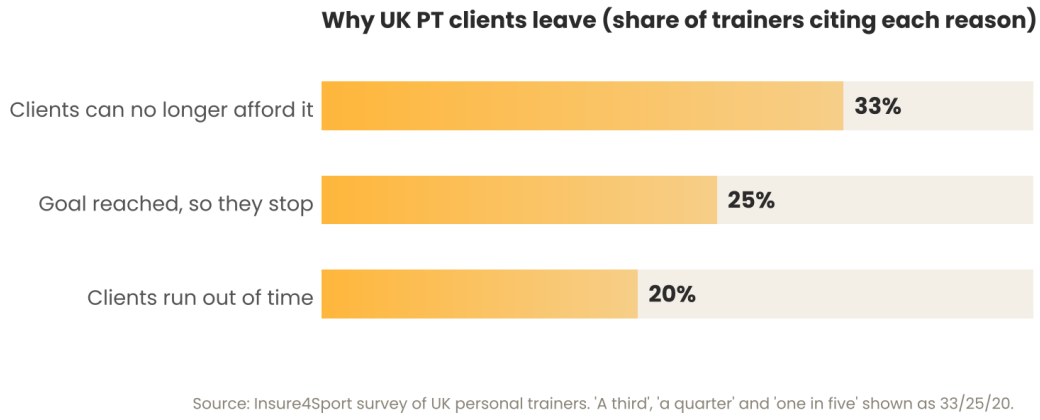
~50%
of leavers say they never felt a personal bond

Why it hurts

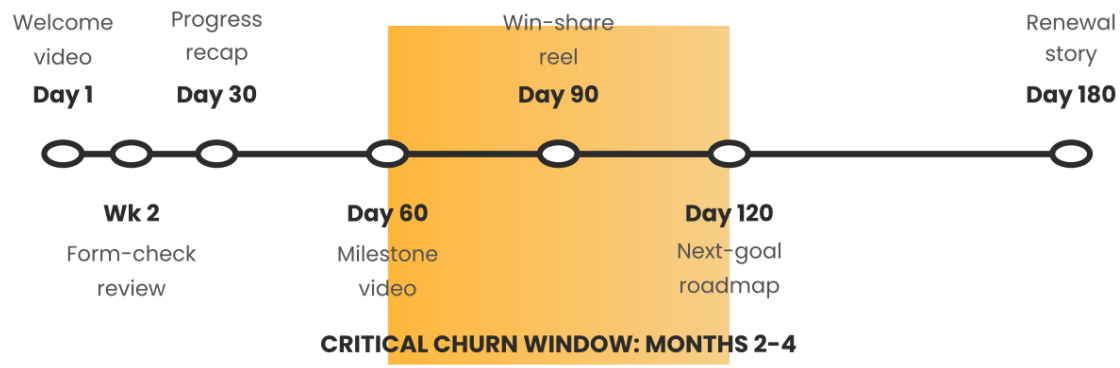
Retention data from health-coaching platforms puts annual churn at 30-40%, with the riskiest stretch in months 2-4. A 30-client trainer at about 33% churn can lose over $25,000 a year in revenue and replacement costs.

The causes are rarely the program. Cost pressure, a plateau in motivation, life disruptions and relationship drift explain most exits, and 60% of clients who reached their goal reportedly left because no follow-up plan was offered (PTDC, via Trainero).

Because clients rarely announce they are leaving, silence is the signal. Platform data cited by Gymkee (from Wodify) suggests about 20 days of inactivity is the point where saving a client gets hard.



Source: Insure4Sport survey of UK personal trainers. 'A third', 'a quarter' and 'one in five' shown as 33/25/20.



01 | Client churn and weak retention

Content-led solutions (4 approaches)

1 Milestone journey videos

Replace generic check-ins with a scripted video touchpoint at Day 1, Week 2, Day 30, Day 60, Day 90 and Day 120. Each is a 45-90 second personal clip, edited with the client's own numbers animated on screen (weight, lifts, streaks, habits).

Content to make: Welcome video, form-check review, monthly progress recap with motion graphics, 'you're 60 days in' milestone clip.

Track: 90-day retention (healthy range is 75-80%), average client tenure.

2 Graduation-to-next-level content

Sixty percent of goal-achievers leave because nobody shows them what comes next. Make 'what's next' a produced asset: a roadmap video and a maintenance or advanced tier they can say yes to in one tap.

Content to make: 'Your next 90 days' roadmap video, 12-month client case study reels, maintenance-tier explainer.

Track: Reactivation rate, share of graduates who re-enrol.

3 Community and win-sharing content

Belonging is the cheapest retention tool. Turn client wins (with written permission) into weekly shareable clips and a monthly recap that clients watch together in the group chat.

Content to make: Weekly 'wins' reel, monthly community recap video, leaderboard and streak graphics.

Track: Check-in rate, referral count per client.

4 Early-warning save sequence

Treat a drop from three sessions to two to one as a churn trajectory. Trigger a short, warm voice or video note after the first missed week, before guilt turns into silence.

Content to make: 'Saw you missed this week' 20-second video note, 'no judgement, here's an easier version' clip.

Track: Win-back rate within 14 days of a missed week.

02

Price pressure and unstable income

Cost is the number-one reason clients walk, and income swings month to month.

1 in 3
UK PTs lose clients because they can no longer afford sessions

$1,000+
typical monthly income swing for a trainer

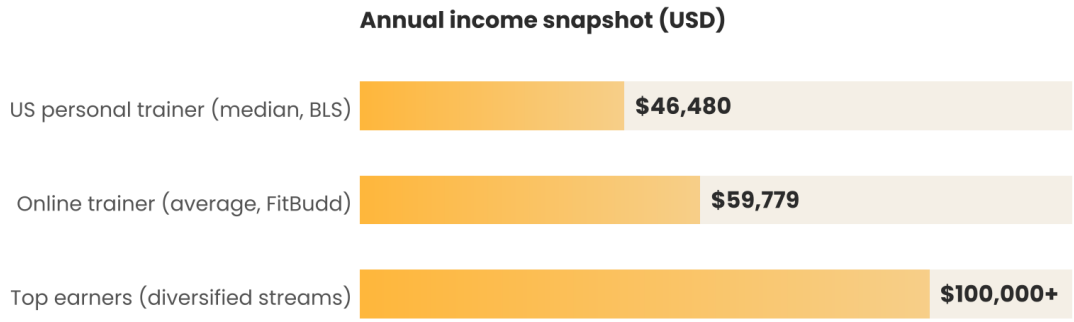
28%
higher average pay for trainers who coach online (FitBudd)

Why it hurts

An Insure4Sport survey of UK trainers found affordability is the top reason clients leave, ahead of time constraints and clients feeling their goal is reached.

Trainer income is lumpy. Seasonal dips, cancellations and a low ceiling on billable hours mean one bad month can wipe out a good one. Median US pay sits near $46,480 (BLS) while online trainers report averages close to $59,800.

Discounting is the instinctive response, but it trains clients to expect lower prices. The stronger answer is making value visible and giving price-sensitive people a lower-cost way in.



Sources: BLS via NFPT / Gerald; FitBudd 2026. Online average is 28% above the in-person average per FitBudd. Figures vary widely by source.

02 | Price pressure and unstable income

Content-led solutions (3 approaches)

1

Value-proof and objection-handling videos

Answer 'it's too expensive' with a video, not a discount. Show what a month actually includes, what a client's results cost per week, and how your price compares with the real cost of not changing.

Content to make: 'What a month with me looks like' explainer, cost-per-outcome graphic, 5 price-objection answers as short clips.

Track: Close rate on sales calls, discount requests per month.

2

Entry-level offer ladder

Give people a lower-ticket way to start: a challenge, a group programme or an app tier, then a path up to 1:1. The ladder keeps price-sensitive clients inside your brand instead of losing them to a free app.

Content to make: Offer-explainer videos for each rung, comparison graphic (challenge vs group vs 1:1), launch teaser series.

Track: Share of new clients entering at the lower tier, upgrade rate.

3

Seasonal campaign calendar for steady cash

Plan content around the demand curve (January reset, pre-summer, September restart) and the retention dips (summer, December) so recurring revenue fills the gaps.

Content to make: Quarterly campaign plan, pre-recorded seasonal promo reels, 'before you go on holiday' retention clip.

Track: Monthly recurring revenue variance.

03 AI coaches and apps eroding perceived value

Almost every coach now uses AI, and clients can get a free plan in seconds.

91%
of coaches now use AI in their business (FitBudd 2026)

10%
of consumers prefer an AI workout over a human-led one

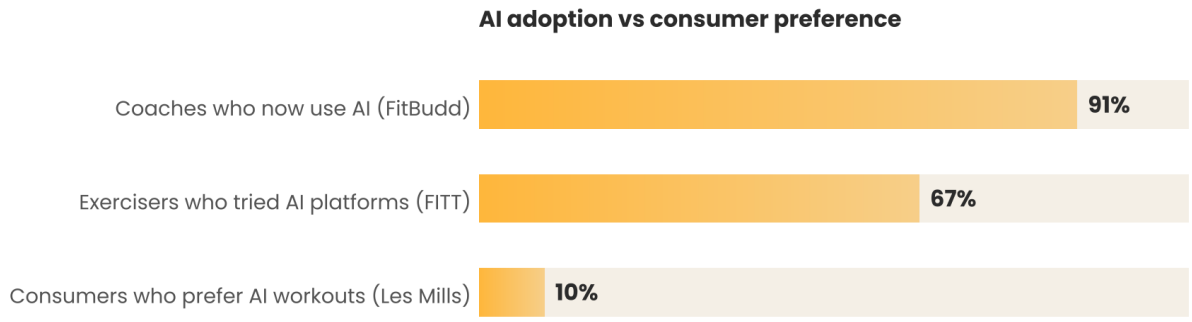
2/3
of exercisers have tried AI-powered fitness platforms

Why it hurts

Apps now handle exercise selection, progression and periodisation well enough that a generic programme no longer feels like a premium product. A 2026 trend report notes that some people are even building their own training apps.

The market is also showing limits. Les Mills' 2026 survey of 10,000+ people found only 10% prefer AI-led training, and in June 2026 coaching app Future shifted its premium tier back toward human coaches.

The real threat, per coaches surveyed by FitBudd, is not AI taking the job but other coaches using AI better. Accountability and empathy are what AI cannot automate.



Sources: FitBudd 2026 AI report; FITT Insider (Feb 2026, 'two-thirds'); Les Mills 2026 Global Fitness Report (10,000+ consumers).

03 | AI coaches and apps eroding perceived value

Content-led solutions (3 approaches)

1

'Human advantage' demonstration content

Show, do not claim, what an app cannot do: spot a rounded back on camera, adapt a plan when a client has a bad week, talk someone through a hard moment. Position it as education, not an attack on apps.

Content to make: 'AI plan vs coach-adjusted plan' side-by-side, form-correction clips with on-screen annotations, voice-note walkthroughs.

Track: Inbound enquiries mentioning personalisation, engagement on proof posts.

2

Use AI behind the scenes, keep the human on camera

Use AI for scripting, captions, repurposing and admin so you publish more, while your face, voice and judgement stay central. A short transparency video on how you use it builds trust.

Content to make: 'How I use AI and where I don't' explainer, behind-the-scenes workflow clip.

Track: Hours saved per week, posts published per week.

3

Branded methodology

A named, visual signature system is harder to replace than a plan. Animate the framework once and reuse it everywhere so clients associate the results with you.

Content to make: Animated framework explainer, 'the 4 phases' series, signature-method intro sting.

Track: Branded search and DM mentions, share of clients referencing the method.

04 Rising acquisition costs and a saturated market

Paid leads are expensive, conversion is thin, and everyone is posting the same thing.

$150-300
typical cost to acquire one PT client through digital ads

5-10%
lead-to-paying-client conversion on paid leads

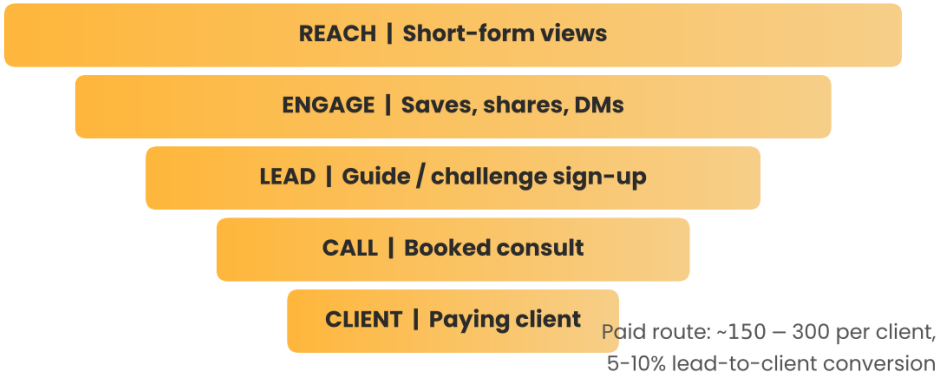
5-7x
cost of acquiring a client vs keeping one

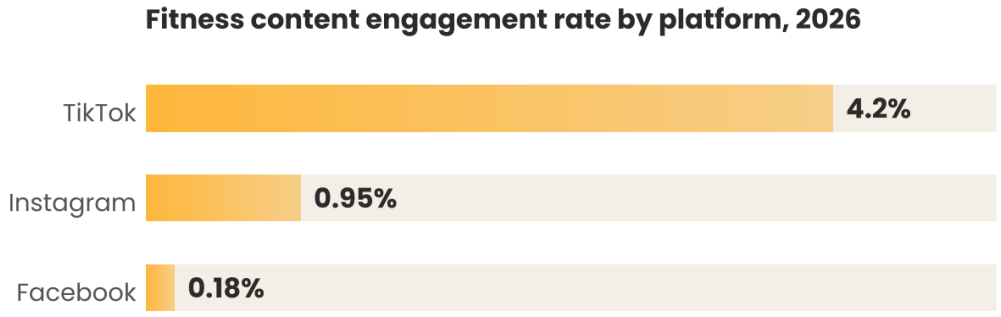
Why it hurts

Independent trainers who rely on ads report spending $150-$300 per signed client, with only 5-10% of leads converting. Studio owners describe the same squeeze as local competition and ad costs both rise.

Organic reach is still the best lever, but it is uneven. One 2026 benchmark puts TikTok fitness engagement at 4.2% against 0.95% for Instagram, and TikTok ads at around $12.80 per lead, the lowest among major channels.

Many coaches also fail after the lead arrives: they start conversations but never close, or have no single, clear next step.





Source: CuFinder 2026 fitness and wellness benchmarks, via Webtonic.

04 | Rising acquisition costs and a saturated market

Content-led solutions (4 approaches)

1

Niche-specific short-form engine

Pick one audience (for example, busy parents over 40 or desk workers with back pain) and post three to five short videos a week built on hook, value, proof and call to action. Niche beats volume in a saturated feed.

Content to make: Problem-led hooks, 30-second myth-busters, 'day in my client's life' clips, captioned for sound-off viewing.

Track: Reach, saves and shares per post, profile visits to DMs.

2

Lead magnet plus comment-to-DM funnel

Every video offers one free thing (a guide, a 7-day plan, a challenge). A comment keyword triggers an automatic DM that delivers it, qualifies the lead and books a call.

Content to make: Lead-magnet promo reels, keyword call-to-action overlay, 3-message DM script with a booking link.

Track: Lead-to-call rate, cost per booked call.

3

Proof-led paid creative

Do not pay to boost random posts. Take the top organic videos and client testimonials, cut them into ad variations with three different hooks, then test and retarget video viewers.

Content to make: Testimonial ads, 3 hook variants per concept, retargeting video for viewers who did not book.

Track: Cost per lead, cost per client, ROAS.

4

Local and partner collaboration content

Co-create content with physios, nutritionists, local gyms or complementary creators to borrow trust and reach without ad spend.

Content to make: Joint Q&A; clips, 'ask the physio' series, partner swap features.

Track: Referral leads per month.

05 Content burnout, inconsistency and algorithm pressure

Coaches have to be creators now, and the feed punishes inconsistency.

Social
is the primary client-acquisition channel for fitness coaches (Heropost)

Plateau
is where coaches end up if they only post when inspired

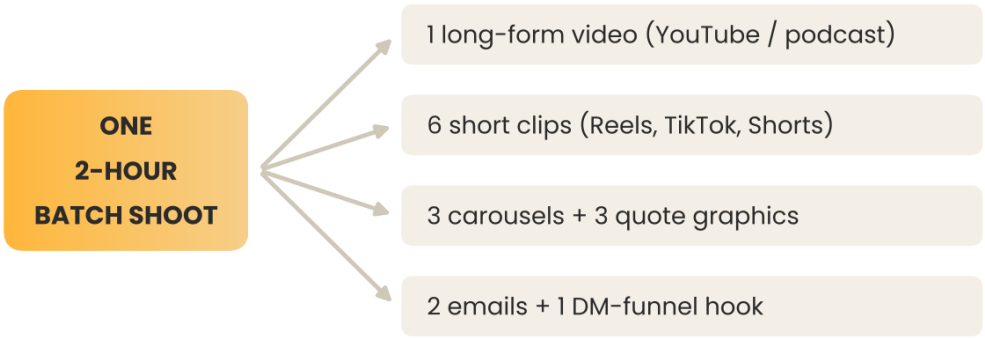
4.2%
TikTok fitness engagement vs 0.95% on Instagram (CuFinder)

Why it hurts

Industry commentary now argues the most successful PTs are the best brand-builders and content marketers, not necessarily the best coaches. That creates a second full-time job.

Coaches who post only when inspired tend to plateau, while consistent publishers compound. At the same time algorithms reward sensational, high-frequency content, pushing some creators toward extreme or misleading posts.

Editing is the hidden bottleneck. Shooting is quick; cutting, captioning, sound and thumbnails are where hours disappear.





05 | Content burnout, inconsistency and algorithm pressure

Content-led solutions (4 approaches)

1

Batch-shoot system with content pillars

Record once a week for two hours and turn it into the whole week's publishing. Balance Educate, Prove, Story and Offer so the feed teaches, builds belief, shows personality and sells, without every post being a pitch.

Content to make: Weekly batch script template, 4-pillar content calendar, shot list for client sessions.

Track: Posts published vs planned, time spent per post.

2

Repurposing pipeline

One long-form talking-head or workout video becomes six shorts, a carousel, a newsletter and several quote graphics. Hand the cutting to an editor so your time goes on coaching.

Content to make: Weekly long-form video, clip extraction with captions, auto-resized variants for each platform.

Track: Content pieces per recording, cost per finished video.

3

Reusable motion kit

A consistent set of intros, lower thirds, caption styles, transitions and thumbnail templates cuts editing time and makes your content recognisable in three seconds.

Content to make: Brand caption style, animated lower third with credentials, reusable transitions and sound design.

Track: Edit time per video, brand recall.

4

Evergreen recycling

Your best posts of the last six months are new to most of your followers. Re-cut and re-post proven winners with fresh hooks rather than inventing weekly.

Content to make: 'Greatest hits' refresh reels, updated hook versions of top posts.

Track: Reach on recycled vs new posts.

06

Trust and credibility crisis

Misinformation, fake 'naturals' and AI-generated bodies make audiences sceptical.

89%
say video quality affects how much they trust a brand

85%
say a video has convinced them to buy

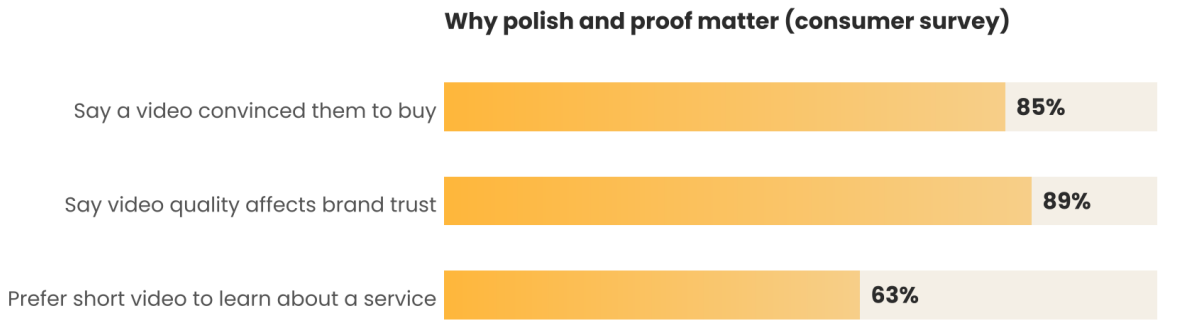
63%
prefer short video to learn about a product or service

Why it hurts

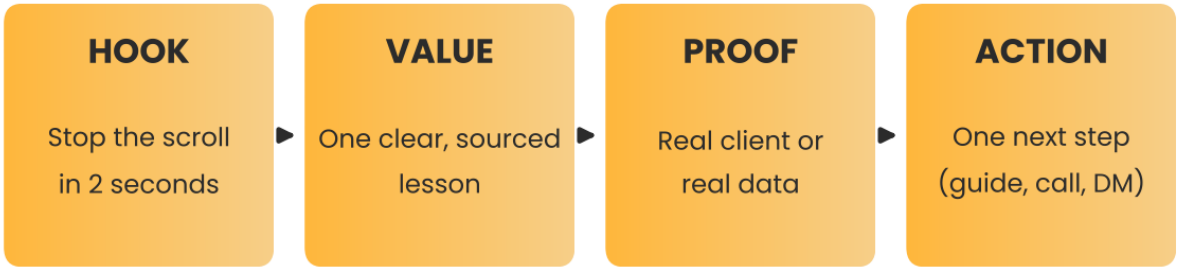
A June 2026 NPR/WBUR segment highlights that 'fitfluencer' content can be harmful, false, and increasingly AI-generated. Commentators also point to undisclosed enhancement and faked weights driven by algorithm incentives.

For genuine coaches this is both a threat and an opening. Audiences cannot easily tell expertise from performance, so credentials, sources and honest results become the differentiator.

Presentation counts too: Wyzowl's 2026 survey finds video quality directly shapes trust.



Source: Wyzowl State of Video Marketing 2026 (consumer sample). Self-reported influence, not conversion rates.



06 | Trust and credibility crisis

Content-led solutions (4 approaches)

1

Evidence-first education series

Make sourcing visible. Put credentials in a lower third, cite the study or guideline on screen, and run a recurring 'myth or fact' series that corrects bad advice calmly.

Content to make: 'Myth or fact' weekly short, on-screen source cards, certification and experience lower third.

Track: Saves and shares on education posts, comments quoting your sources.

2

Transparent proof content

Show full journeys, including setbacks, timeframes and typical results, rather than only dramatic before-and-afters. Add honest context so prospects know what is realistic.

Content to make: Client case-study video with timeline and data, 'what's typical' explainer, raw behind-the-scenes session clips.

Track: Booked-call rate from proof posts.

3

Production quality as a trust signal

Clean audio, steady framing, accurate captions and a consistent look tell viewers you take the work seriously. Poor sound loses more viewers than poor lighting.

Content to make: Audio clean-up, brand-matched captions, consistent colour grade and intro.

Track: Average watch time, completion rate.

4

Live Q&A; and credibility stack

Regular lives and recorded Q&As; let people test your knowledge in real time. Collect the clips into a trust page alongside certifications, press and reviews.

Content to make: Monthly live Q&A;, 'ask me anything' highlight reel, trust-page video.

Track: Live attendance, DM questions per week.

07

Online delivery: accountability, compliance and form safety

Without a trainer in the room, motivation drops, form slips and courses go unfinished.

87%
of self-paced fitness courses are abandoned (Communipass)

40-60%
completion for timed challenges vs 5-15% for courses

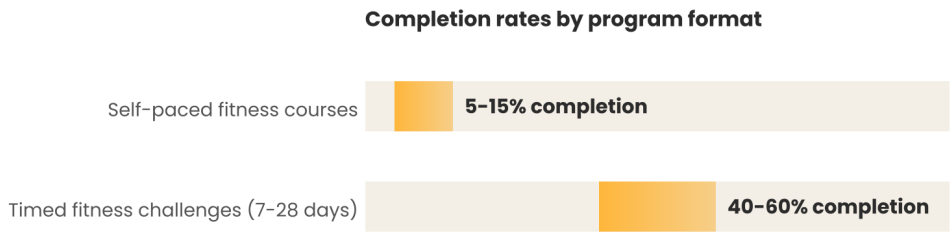
Form
and safety are harder to teach and verify remotely (ISSA)

Why it hurts

Online coaching makes it harder to confirm clients actually do the work, to judge effort and to correct technique in real time. ISSA notes this makes online less ideal for complete beginners.

Format matters. Self-paced courses are abandoned at very high rates, while time-boxed challenges with daily prompts reportedly reach far higher completion.

A reader survey of women over 40 (shared in the Go Long newsletter) found many dropped trainers because they were injured, felt unheard, or never had the 'why' explained. It is informal evidence but points at the same gap.



Source: Communipass (2026). Vendor-published figures; treat as indicative. Self-paced courses are abandoned by roughly 87% per the same source.

07 | Online delivery: accountability, compliance and form safety

Content-led solutions (3 approaches)

1

Annotated form library and video feedback loop

Build a library of short exercise demos from two or three angles with common mistakes called out on screen, then review client form-check videos with a voice-over and drawn corrections.

Content to make: Slow-motion technique clips, 'fix this mistake' series, annotated client review videos.

Track: Injury or pain reports, form-check submissions per client.

2

Challenge-format programmes

Replace open-ended courses with 7-28 day challenges that use daily micro-video prompts, a clear finish line and a post-challenge offer for the people who completed.

Content to make: Daily 30-60 second challenge videos, countdown teasers, completion-day celebration reel.

Track: Challenge completion rate, post-challenge conversion.

3

Micro-learning 'why' videos

Explain why each phase of the plan exists in a short video so clients feel informed rather than instructed. Informed clients comply more and complain less.

Content to make: 60-second phase explainers, 'why we're doing this' intro for each new block.

Track: Check-in compliance, programme completion.

08 Trainer burnout and attrition

Low barriers to entry, heavy admin and uneven income push most trainers out early.

~80%
of trainers reportedly leave within 1-2 years (industry estimate)

Admin
workload and financial pressure are top reasons coaches quit (UK Coaching)

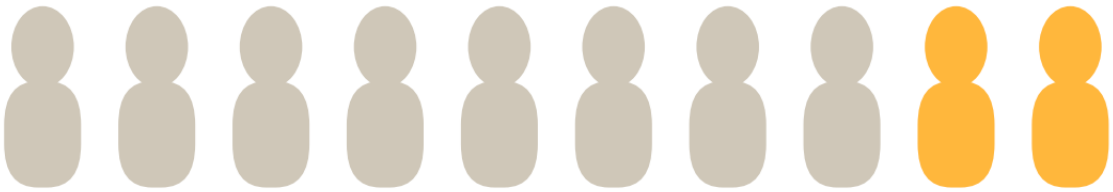
18.5
hours per week the average trainer spends across two facilities

Why it hurts

The commonly cited estimate is that most trainers leave the profession within about two years. It is not a rigorous statistic, but UK Coaching's survey of nearly 1,000 coaches backs the pattern: workload, burnout, financial pressure and admin burden drive people out.

Many trainers are great coaches but untrained in sales, marketing and operations. When they spend more time chasing clients than coaching, burnout follows.

Constant availability is part of the load. Online clients message at all hours unless expectations are set early.



About 8 in 10 trainers leave the profession within 1-2 years (commonly cited industry estimate).

08 | Trainer burnout and attrition

Content-led solutions (3 approaches)

1

Systemise delivery and outsource production

Document the repeatable parts of your business (onboarding, check-ins, content) and hand production to an editor or agency. Reclaiming evenings is the highest-return burnout fix.

Content to make: SOP screen-recordings, templated onboarding video, outsourced editing workflow.

Track: Hours worked per week, days off taken.

2

Leverage with group and library offers

Move part of your income from hours to assets: group coaching, challenges and a recorded video library. Revenue stops being tied to every extra session.

Content to make: Group-programme launch video, library trailer, evergreen course lessons.

Track: Revenue per coaching hour.

3

Boundary-setting and community content

Record a welcome video that sets response times, office hours and how to reach you, then run live office hours. Clients behave better when expectations are explicit.

Content to make: 'How coaching with me works' video, weekly office-hours live, community guidelines clip.

Track: After-hours messages per week, client satisfaction.

09 The scaling ceiling and fragmented tools

Trading hours for money caps income, and the tech stack is a patchwork.

86%
of six-figure trainers and nutrition coaches train clients online (Coachway)

+29%
capacity gain from virtual sessions (Schedulingkit)

Many
coaches juggle email, Sheets, Zoom and DMs for one client (Hevy)

Why it hurts

In-person coaching is time-bound and location-bound. Coachway reports that most six-figure coaches have moved online to break that ceiling.

Coaches often run delivery across email, spreadsheets, video calls and messaging apps, which slows replies and frustrates clients as the roster grows.

Scaling without a system either lowers quality or burns the coach out. Productised offers with video content built in solve both.



09 | The scaling ceiling and fragmented tools

Content-led solutions (3 approaches)

1

Productise a signature programme

Package your method into a named programme with a clear promise, duration and outcome. A productised offer is easier to sell, deliver and film once.

Content to make: Programme overview video, module trailers, case-study reel as sales page hero.

Track: Programme enrolments, average order value.

2

Group coaching and membership with a video library

Combine a weekly live session, recorded replays and a library of workout and education videos so one hour of your time serves many clients.

Content to make: Weekly live-class recordings, library trailer, member-onboarding tour.

Track: Member retention, revenue per member.

3

Consolidate the stack and automate onboarding

Move to one coaching platform and automate the first 14 days: a welcome video, intake form, first workout and a scheduled check-in. First impressions become consistent.

Content to make: Automated welcome video series, 'how to use the app' tutorial, FAQ clips.

Track: Time to first workout, onboarding drop-off.

10 Shifting consumer motivation: from aesthetics to longevity and joy

Clients want strength, stress relief and community, but many still see fitness as a chore.

88%
of members want yoga, breathwork or meditation offered

41%
still see fitness as a chore

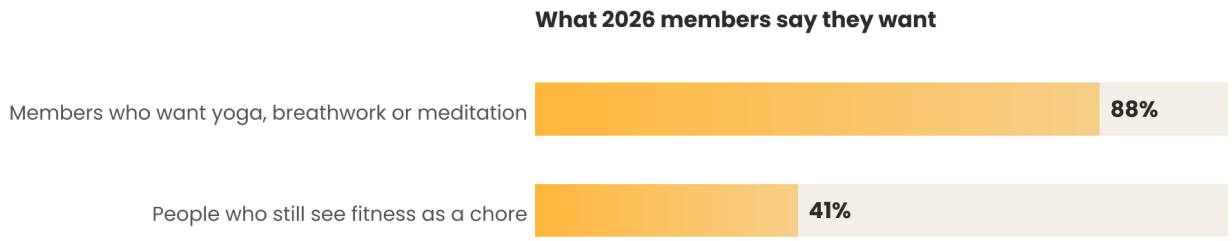
Shift
motivation moving from aesthetics to longevity and stress

Why it hurts

Les Mills' 2026 report describes a shift: members increasingly train for longevity and stress management, with strength training and wellness as the 'power couple'.

Content built only around fat loss and six-packs misses that shift, and it fuels the unhealthy comparison culture that makes fitness feel like a chore.

The opportunity is to talk about energy, mobility and healthspan, and to make training social and enjoyable.



Source: Les Mills 2026 Global Fitness Report (10,000+ consumers, five continents).

10 | Shifting consumer motivation: from aesthetics to longevity and joy

Content-led solutions (3 approaches)

1

Longevity and strength-for-life storytelling

Reframe results around energy, injury resilience and long-term independence. Share stories of clients who can now play with grandkids or hike without pain rather than only weight lost.

Content to make: 'Strong at 60' client stories, healthspan explainer series, daily-life strength tests.

Track: Engagement on outcome-focused posts, enquiry quality.

2

Joyful and social content formats

Make fitness feel less like homework: partner workouts, playful challenges, community meetups and behind-the-scenes laughs. Show the experience, not only the exercise.

Content to make: Group-session highlight reels, fun fitness challenges, 'worst warm-up ever' bloopers.

Track: Shares, tags and community sign-ups.

3

Add wellness micro-modules

Short mobility, breathwork and recovery sessions broaden your offer and answer the 88% who want them. Partner with a specialist if it is outside your scope.

Content to make: 5-minute breathwork and mobility clips, guest-expert collaboration, 'recovery Sunday' series.

Track: Module usage, membership retention.

Content system blueprint

Almost every solution above routes through the same engine: a repeatable weekly content system built on four pillars, one hook-value-proof-action structure, and a single batch day. The mix below is a suggested starting point to adapt to your audience, not a research finding.

EDUCATE	PROVE	STORY	OFFER
40%	25%	20%	15%
Myth-busting, form, nutrition basics	Client journeys, results with context	Your why, behind the scenes, lifestyle	Programs, challenges, clear call to action

SUGGESTED WEEKLY CADENCE

MON	TUE	WED	THU	FRI	SAT	SUN
Educate short	Prove client win	Educate carousel	Story reel	Offer CTA reel	Prove long-form	Plan + batch day

The structure of every video

HOOK Stop the scroll in 2 seconds ▶ **VALUE** One clear, sourced lesson ▶ **PROOF** Real client or real data ▶ **ACTION** One next step (guide, call, DM)

Rules that keep it sustainable

- Shoot once a week, edit through a template, publish on a schedule.
- Give every video exactly one next step, never three.
- Always attach a source, a result or a real person to a claim.
- Review KPIs monthly: retention, cost per booked call, completion rate and posts shipped.

90-day action roadmap

A coach starting from scratch can sequence the highest-impact content work in three 30-day blocks. Fix retention and delivery first, because new leads are wasted if the bucket leaks, then build acquisition, then scale what already works.

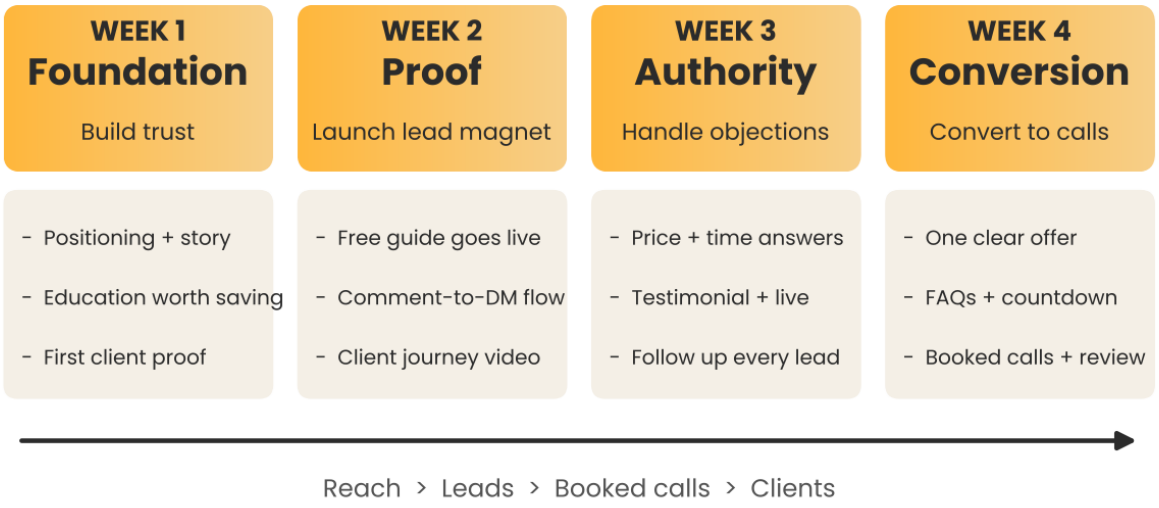
DAYS 1-30 Fix the foundation	DAYS 31-60 Build the engine	DAYS 61-90 Scale what works
- Pick one niche + method	- 3-5 shorts per week	- Turn top posts into ads
- Batch-shoot system live	- Lead magnet + DM funnel	- Launch a 21-day challenge
- Welcome + form videos	- Journey videos in place	- Review churn + KPIs

Quick wins this week

- Record a 60-second welcome video and send it to every new client.
- Write down the three objections you hear most and record one 30-second answer each.
- Block two hours for a first batch shoot and cut it into five shorts.
- Set a calendar reminder to review each client's attendance every 14 days.

30-day demo content plan

A ready-to-adapt month of content built to do one job: turn attention into booked calls and signed clients. It is a demo for a typical online or hybrid fitness coach. Every day lists the exact topic to post and what to show and say. The example coach helps busy people lose fat and get stronger in 3 workouts a week; swap in your own niche and offer, and keep the structure.



How the month works

- **Content mix:** 8 Educate, 5 Prove, 5 Story, 8 Offer posts, plus 4 plan and review days (Days 7, 14, 21 and 30).
- **One lead magnet:** a free 7-day kickstart guide. A keyword comment (for example 'START') triggers an automatic DM that delivers it.
- **One conversion path:** video, keyword comment, DM conversation, free 15-minute call, then a 21-day challenge or 1:1 spot.
- **Time needed:** one 2-hour batch shoot per week plus 20 minutes a day for replies. Editing can be outsourced.
- **Formats are flexible:** reels, TikToks and Shorts are interchangeable. Post the same short on all three.

This is a demo plan: the niche, keywords and offer are examples to adapt, and results depend on your niche, offer and consistency. The mix leans toward offers and proof because the goal is conversion; the 40/25/20/15 mix in the content system blueprint is the general starting point.

Plan | Days 1-7

Week 1: Foundation: build trust and visibility

Focus: Introduce who you help and how. Publish education that earns saves, one personal story and a first piece of proof. Every topic below is written for an example coach who helps busy people lose fat and get stronger in 3 workouts a week.

Day	Format	Exact topic to post	Content idea (what to show and say)	Call to action
1	Short reel **Educate**	**3 reasons you quit every new workout plan by week 3**	Talk to camera. Three on-screen cards: too extreme, no schedule, no tracking. Finish with the fix: start with only 2 sessions a week.	Follow for daily tips
2	Carousel **Educate**	**The 20-minute full-body workout for people with no time**	7 slides, one exercise per slide with a photo, sets and reps. Last slide is a 'save this for your next workout' card.	Save this post
3	Short reel **Story**	**The moment I decided to become a coach**	30 seconds: your real low point, the turning moment, one lesson. Film it in the gym with b-roll of you training.	DM me 'HI'
4	Short reel **Educate**	**Myth: you have to cut carbs to lose fat**	Say the myth, flip to the fact. Show a cited source on screen and a simple balanced plate with protein, carbs and veg.	Share with a friend
5	Short reel **Prove**	**A client win: what changed in 10 weeks**	Use a real client (written permission). Show the starting point, the 2 habits that changed and the result. Focus on habits, not only photos.	Comment 'START' for the free guide
6	Stories **Story**	**Poll: what is stopping you right now?**	Poll with 4 options: time, food, motivation, not knowing what to do. Add a question box. Replies become next week's topics.	Vote and reply
7	Plan day **Plan**	**Batch-shoot Week 2 and build the lead magnet**	Write the free 7-day kickstart guide (1 workout and 1 habit per day). Set up the 'START' comment-to-DM automation and test it yourself.	Test the full flow

Production note: Shoot Days 1-5 in one 2-hour batch. Edit with captions, a consistent intro and an on-screen credentials lower third.

Plan | Days 8-14

Week 2: Proof: launch the lead magnet

Focus: Show you can fix a real problem, then put the free guide in front of the audience that reacted in Week 1. Every video gets one clear next step.

Day	Format	Exact topic to post	Content idea (what to show and say)	Call to action
8	Short reel **Educate**	**Fix your squat in 20 seconds**	Side-view clip in slow motion. Three on-screen annotations: knees, chest, depth. Show the wrong rep, then the corrected rep.	Comment 'FORM' for the video guide
9	Long-form video **Educate**	**How to start training when you're busy: a 3-day week, step by step**	10-15 min walkthrough. Screen-share a weekly calendar: 3 workouts, 2 prepared meals, 1 long walk. Cut into 3 shorts later.	Subscribe / follow
10	Short reel **Prove**	**60 days with a busy parent: what worked and what didn't**	Timeline graphic of the client journey. Include one honest bad week and how you adjusted the plan.	Comment 'START'
11	Carousel **Offer**	**What's inside the free 7-day kickstart guide**	One slide per day (Day 1 to Day 7), who it is for, and how long each day takes. Last slide: the keyword.	Comment 'START'
12	Short reel **Offer**	**Free 7-day kickstart: how to get it in 10 seconds**	Show the guide on a phone screen and scroll it. Say the keyword on camera and show the DM arriving.	Comment 'START'
13	Stories **Story**	**A day in my training week**	Behind the scenes: your workout, a client check-in, a meal prep shot. Add a question box: 'Ask me anything about fat loss'.	Send me a question
14	Plan day **Plan**	**Review Weeks 1-2 and shoot Week 3**	Check reach, saves, DMs and guide requests. Note which hook got the most saves and reuse that hook style.	Reply to every lead within 24h

Production note: Cut the long-form video on Day 9 into three extra shorts for Week 3. Reuse the caption style from Week 1 for consistency.

Plan | Days 15-21

Week 3: Authority: handle objections, deepen belief

Focus: Leads from Week 2 are now warm. Answer the questions that stop people buying (price, time, 'will it work for me') and show real testimonials.

Day	Format	Exact topic to post	Content idea (what to show and say)	Call to action
15	Short reel **Educate**	**Myth: you need to train fasted to burn more fat**	Myth-then-fact format again. Show the source on screen and give one practical rule: train when you can be consistent.	Share with a friend
16	Short reel **Prove**	**'I almost didn't hire a coach.' A client explains why**	30-45 sec subtitled testimonial. Client names one doubt (price or time) and one specific result.	Comment 'START'
17	Short reel **Offer**	**Is online coaching worth the money? What you actually get in a month**	Screen-record the real deliverables: your plan, weekly check-in, form feedback and message support. End with what happens if nothing changes.	DM 'PRICE' for the options
18	Live Q&A **Educate**	**Live: your fat-loss questions, answered**	30-minute live. Answer questions from your Stories box and polls. Save the replay and cut 5 clips.	Ask your question live
19	Short reel **Story**	**My client wanted to quit in month 2. Here's what I told them**	Short story: the message they sent, what you answered, what changed. End with a lesson viewers can use.	Save for when you need it
20	Carousel **Prove**	**What a before-and-after photo doesn't show**	Slides: timeframe, workouts per week, bad weeks, what was typical. Honest context builds trust.	Comment 'START'
21	Plan day **Plan**	**Follow up with every guide downloader**	Message everyone who took the guide but has not replied (use Message 3 of the DM flow). Shoot Week 4.	Offer a free 15-minute call

Production note: Record the testimonial on Day 16 with clean audio. Turn the live Q&A replay into five clips for next week.

Plan | Days 22-30

Week 4: Conversion: turn warm leads into booked calls

Focus: Make one clear offer (a 21-day challenge or limited 1:1 spots) and give people a simple way to say yes. Use proof, FAQs and scarcity that is real.

Day	Format	Exact topic to post	Content idea (what to show and say)	Call to action
22	Short reel **Offer**	**Starting Monday: the 21-day Strong Start challenge**	Who it is for, what they get (3 workouts a week, daily check-in, meal guide), start date, number of spots.	Comment 'CHALLENGE'
23	Short reel **Educate**	**What Day 1 of the challenge looks like**	Show the real Day 1: the 20-minute workout, the meal template and the check-in message.	Comment 'CHALLENGE'
24	Short reel **Prove**	**Two clients, two goals, one simple system**	Split screen of two client results with timelines and a one-line quote each.	DM 'READY'
25	Short reel **Offer**	**This challenge is NOT for you if...**	List 3 people it is not for (wants a quick fix, can't train 3 times a week, won't check in). Builds trust and filters leads.	Book a free call
26	Live **Offer**	**Free 20-minute workout live, then Q&A**	Train live with followers, then answer questions about the challenge and invite attendees to book a call.	Book a free call
27	Stories **Offer**	**Countdown: 48 hours to join**	Countdown sticker, testimonial screenshots and replies to the top 3 questions (price, time, equipment).	DM 'CHALLENGE'
28	Short reel + email **Offer**	**Last call: the challenge starts tomorrow**	Short reel with the final spots left and a 3-line email to the guide list with the booking link.	Book before midnight
29	Short reel **Story**	**What this month taught me about what you want**	Share the top 3 questions you received and what you learned. Thank new members and tease next month.	Follow for next month
30	Review day **Plan**	**Score the month and plan month two**	Fill the scorecard, re-cut the top 3 posts with new hooks, and plan the next 30 days.	Update the tracker

Production note: Prepare the challenge welcome video and the booking link before Day 22. Schedule Day 28 email and Stories countdown in advance.

Plan | Playbook and scorecard

Turning leads into clients

The 3-message DM flow

Message 1: deliver	Hey [name], here's your free 7-day kickstart guide: [link]. Quick question so I can point you to the right part: what's your main goal right now?
Message 2: qualify	Thanks for sharing. What has got in the way of that so far: time, motivation, not knowing what to do, or something else?
Message 3: invite	That's really common and fixable. I do a free 15-minute call to map out a first step, no pressure. Want me to send you my booking link?

The 15-minute call

1. Goal	Ask what they want and why it matters now.
2. Gap	Where are they today, and what has stopped them before?
3. Plan	Describe the first 30 days in plain language.
4. Offer	Present one option and the price. Do not discount in the call.
5. Next step	Ask for the decision or book a follow-up within 48 hours.

Month-end scorecard

Metric	Where to find it	What it tells you
Pieces published	Posting tool / platform	Planned: 26 content days + 4 plan/review days
Reach and saves	Platform analytics	Which hooks earn saves and shares
Guide requests	DM tool / email list	Keyword comments and downloads
Conversations started	DMs	Replies to Message 1
Calls booked	Calendar	Booked from DMs and lives
Show rate	Calendar	Attended / booked
Clients signed	Payments	Challenge or 1:1 sign-ups
Cost per signed client	Spend / signed clients	Compare with the $150-300 paid benchmark

Fill in the numbers weekly. Set your own targets after the first month, using your baseline rather than a generic benchmark.

How Motionholic can help

Motionholic is a video editing and motion design agency for coaches and creators. Most of the solutions in this report depend on producing consistent, high-quality video, which is the part coaches are least able to do themselves while also coaching. This is where we can take the load.

Short-form editing
Captioned, hook-led shorts from your raw footage, delivered on a weekly schedule.

Client journey videos
Milestone recaps with animated progress data and branded templates.

Testimonial and case-study edits
Honest, well-paced proof content for organic and paid use.

Motion kit and brand system
Reusable captions, intros, lower thirds and thumbnails.

Challenge and course video
Daily micro-videos and library lessons with consistent polish.

Ad creative
Three-hook variants of your best-performing organic content.

Get in touch

Website: motionholic.com
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Methodology, data notes and sources

Research method

Findings were gathered from web research on 13 October 2026, covering consumer surveys, trade publications, coaching-software research and industry commentary published mostly in 2026. Figures were paraphrased and attributed to their original publisher. Where a number comes from a vendor that sells to coaches, or from commentary rather than a survey, it is labelled indicative.

Caveats

- Market segments are defined differently by each publisher, so figures are not additive.
- The '80% of trainers leave within 1-2 years' figure is a widely repeated industry estimate, not a verified statistic.
- Churn, cost-per-client and completion figures come from software vendors and should be treated as benchmarks to test against your own data.
- Solutions are recommendations drawn from the evidence, not guaranteed outcomes.

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